Physical and Chemical Changes



Physical Changes

A physical change occurs when a substance changes in some way but no new substance is formed. When water is changed to a solid or a gas, the ice, water and steam are different states of the same substance. As no new substance is formed this change is known as a physical change. When a pencil is sharpened another type of physical change takes place. Some of the wood and graphite are changed to shavings. However, no new substance is formed.



Chemical Changes

A chemical change occurs when one or more substance changes to form one or more new substances. At certain times of the year, people living near a river or the sea complain about terrible smells that come from seaweed or other dead matter washed up on the shore. The smell is due to these substances decaying. In the decaying process new substances are formed. A chemical change has taken place.



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